

Counsel Packet — Steppe (Trust & Safety · Verification Retention · Governance · COI · Budget)

Prepared 2026-07-08; governance & COI documents added the same day. A consolidated bundle for Oregon nonprofit / platform-liability counsel. **Every document here is DRAFT pending counsel review — none is a legal instrument, and none has force until adopted.**

1. Alignment status: EXECUTED (2026-06-27)

The privacy/terms alignment to the verify-then-forget posture was carried out in two commits, both dated **2026-06-27**:

- **d6db153** — docs(privacy): align /privacy copy with verification-retention posture (edited steppe/messages/en.json + es.json, “privacy” namespace)
- **8f13a3f** — docs(terms): add /legal/terms aligned with the trust & safety posture (added steppe/content/legal/terms.md + the /legal/terms page)

Both surfaces state the posture correctly:

Requirement (decision record §1, §7)	/privacy	/legal/terms
Evidence deleted immediately	✓ “we delete what you sent” / “then delete the proof”	✓ “the proof is deleted the moment that check is made” / “deleted immediately after the residency check”
Retain flag / date / method only	✓ “keep only that you’re verified, the date, and the method”	✓ “we retain only the verified status, the date, and the method”
“Can’t disclose” scoped to verification, not all data	✓ “Because we don’t keep the proof, we can’t produce or disclose it”	✓ same, and explicit that “account details and content within their retention window do exist and may be subject to lawful disclosure”

2. Documents in this packet

Trust & safety / verification retention:

#	Document	Source path	Last commit (content)
01	/privacy page	steppe/app/(site)/privacy/pages + steppe/messages/en.json	d6db153 (2026-06-27); component ae429a (2026-06-22) (“privacy” namespace)
02	/legal/terms page	steppe/content/legal/terms.md	8f13a3f (2026-06-27)
03	Decision record (canon)	docs/decisions/steppe-ts-verification-decision-record.md	bfb4fb4 (2026-07-04)
04	Consent / membership agreement (“Terms of Membership” + Privacy, documents table v0.1, rendered at /welcome)	seed/documents-terms-privacy-v0.1.sql	38ccbc9 (2026-07-08)

Governance & entity (nonprofit / 501(c)(3)):

#	Document	Source path	Status
05	Governance Charter & Bylaws (ORS 65 / intended 501(c)(3); Business Plan v12 basis)	docs/governance/Steppe-Governance-Charter-v0.2-DRAFT.md (+ .docx)	Working Draft v0.2 — NOT YET ADOPTED
07	COI Register	docs/governance/steppe-coi-register-v2.md	v2 (2026-07-08)

Removed 2026-07-10: documents **06** (COI Disclosure Packet — individual disclosure forms) and **10** (Annex A, pre-counsel review notes) were removed from the repository and this packet and are retained privately; they go to counsel directly, not through the repo. Numbering keeps their gaps — the packet now carries **9 files** (00-05, 07-09).

Source model (corrected 2026-07-08): the governance sources now live in docs/governance/. The real .docx are **tracked** (.gitignore only ignores Word lock files ~\$*.docx) — the earlier “gitignored” note was wrong. Markdown (.md) is the tracked source-of-truth; the .docx are the editable/signature copies, regenerated from the markdown via pandoc. Superseded originals are in docs/governance/superseded/. See docs/governance/README.md for the folder index and the **firm-vs-living document status** classification.

This review pass (2026-07-08) updated: 05 (§4.2 verification; §8.9 honoraria note) → **v0.2**; 06 (Three Canyon confirmed; Weimer + IEF disclosure) → **v1.4**; 07 (Entry 002) → **v2**; 08 (sponsor confirmed IEF + honoraria resolution). The charter/COI .docx were regenerated from the updated markdown; 09 (Schedule of Defaults) and 10 (review annex) were added.

Financial:

#	Document	Source path	Last commit
08	Operating Budget (staged; PROPOSED planning numbers, not commitments) — fiscal sponsor Ignite Empowerment Foundation , sponsorship agreement pending signature; companion to Business Plan v12	docs/governance/steppe-operating-budget-v1.md	0daa1f1 (2026-07-04); v1.1 this pass

Governance norms & review (added 2026-07-08):

#	Document	Source path	Status
09	Schedule of Defaults (member-governed community norms; fills the gap cited in 03 §3 and 02 §2)	docs/governance/Steppe-Schedule-of-Defaults-v0.1.md (new)	Working Draft v0.1 — NOT YET RATIFIED

3. Contradictions / discrepancies vs the decision record

One material contradiction (governance/COI), addressed in this pass — see Annex A (retained privately; removed from the packet 2026-07-10).

- **[06 ↔ 07 — COI financial relationship. RESOLVED 2026-07-08.]** The COI Disclosure Packet (06) had stated there was *no* financial relationship between Greg Chism and Holli Cobb and relied on that to let each approve the other's interested-person transactions; the COI Register (07, Entry 1) disclosed the opposite. **Confirmed:** the relationship is real and held by **Three Canyon Consulting LLC** (paid engagement with Redmond Compass, Director Cobb's company). 06 was revised to **v1.4** and 07 to **v2** — neither director is disinterested as to the other, and a disinterested body independent of **both** is required.
- **[Fiscal sponsor + board independence. New 2026-07-08.]** The sponsor is confirmed as **Ignite Empowerment Foundation (IEF)** (resolving the earlier IEF-vs-Aspiration discrepancy in favor of IEF; the separate privacy-policy draft still says Aspiration and must be updated). **Director Brandon Weimer is the spouse of IEF's founder** — a new related-party conflict (07, Entry 002) that also means Weimer is not the clean independent director previously assumed. With all three directors entangled, **Steppe plans to seat a fourth, fully independent director. [COUNSEL: §4958 approving-body / recusal map; P0.]**

On the verification-retention posture there remain **no hard contradictions**. Two prior notes:

1. **[RESOLVED 2026-07-08]** The consent-gate **Terms of Membership** (documents v0.1) previously enumerated the retained set as *“the fact that you are verified and which method you used”* — omitting the date. Both spots (Terms §3 and Privacy §3) were updated to *“verified, the date, and ... method”* to match the decision record §1 and the aligned pages. **CLAUDE.md** invariant 1 was likewise updated (it had said “profiles.verified + the method”). The documents table body in this packet (04) reflects the corrected text.
2. **[CONTEXT]** The consent-gate documents (v0.1, 2026-06-14) **predate** the June 27 alignment and were **not** part of the alignment commits — but they already carried verify-then-forget language from the start (“We verify, then forget... documents are deleted as soon as we’ve checked them”), so they are **substantively aligned**. They remain DRAFT v0.1 pending legal review; when counsel returns edits, this consent copy must be updated **alongside** the `/legal/*.md` and `/privacy` surfaces so the three don’t drift.

Filename note: the request referenced `docs/decisions/trust-safety-verification-retention.md`; the record was filed as `steppe-ts-verification-decision-record.md` (the record itself states the originally-suggested name “was not used”).

4. Reviewer annotations (in 02)

`/legal/terms` carries `[CONFIRM ...]` blockquotes (claims for counsel to verify) and `[BRACKET]` placeholders (specifics to fill: effective date, service area, legal entity). The live page strips `[CONFIRM ...]` and stays **noindex** until every placeholder is filled and counsel signs off.

5. Governance & COI — status for counsel

- **Charter & Bylaws (05)** is a **working draft, not yet adopted** (adoption is under its own Article XII). It carries bracketed items and a Schedule A punch list of decisions still to be confirmed.

It is written for revision by the founder and review by qualified Oregon nonprofit counsel — explicitly *not* a legal instrument or legal advice.

- The **COI Disclosure Packet** (individual disclosure forms) is retained privately and goes to counsel directly (removed from the repo 2026-07-10); the public **COI Register (07)** remains the packet's COI record.

All documents are DRAFT pending Oregon nonprofit / platform-liability counsel review — not legal instruments, no force until adopted. This packet is committed to the repo; the COI disclosure forms and the pre-counsel review annex are retained privately and are not.

/PRIVACY PAGE — rendered text Live: <https://www.steppe.community/privacy> Source copy: steppe/messages/en.json “privacy” namespace + steppe/app/(site)/privacy/page.tsx Aligned to verify-then-forget in commit d6db153 (2026-06-27). NOTE: the first ~8 and last ~4 lines below are site nav/footer chrome; the privacy body is between. =====

Vol. I · No. 1 Redmond · Central Oregon · Est. 2026

EN

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ES

[] Steppe

Charter Membership Exchange Preview Contact

Privacy

We have nothing to gain from your data.

Most platforms bury privacy in a menu you have to go find. Here it’s part of what Steppe is: a member-owned nonprofit that runs no ads, keeps no trackers, and has nothing to gain from your information.

Last updated June 2026

[]

Our commitments

Six promises we keep.

a.

We never sell or share your data

There’s no one to sell it to, and no business here that wants it. Steppe runs on member dues, full stop.

b.

No advertising, no ad-tech

No third-party trackers, no advertising pixels, and no behavioral profiles. Nothing watches what you do in order to sell you something or to someone later.

c.

We verify you’re a neighbor, then delete the proof

Membership means showing you live in the area. The moment a person confirms it, we delete what you sent and keep only that you’re verified, the date, and the method — never an ID, a document, or your legal name. To each other, members are known by a username. Because we don’t keep the proof, we can’t produce or disclose it, even under legal process.

d.

Your profile is private by default

Every field starts hidden. You choose, one at a time, whether it’s visible to no one or to members.

e.

Messages stay inside Steppe

Conversations between neighbors stay between neighbors. We don't read them, and we never sell or share them. We keep them only for a limited window, and would hand them over only if valid legal process required it.

f.

You can leave with everything

Export all of your data any time, and delete your account whenever you want. When you go, we delete our copy.

The record

What we collect, and why.

Only what we need to run a verified, member-owned community. Nothing is kept "just in case."

Account basicsRequired

Your email and username, so you can sign in and neighbors can reach you.

While a memberdeleted on leaving

Dues & paymentRequired

Handled by our payment processor. We see that you've paid, and we never store your card.

Processornot held by us

Residency checkOnce

Proof you live in the area. A person reviews it to confirm you're eligible, then it's deleted — we keep only that you passed, the date, and the method.

Deletedthe moment it's checked

What you postYou choose

Listings, messages, group activity, and the votes you cast. You create it, and you can remove it.

Until youdelete it

Minimal logsSecurity

Basic technical records to keep the service running and safe. No tracking profiles.

Short-termthen purged

Your rights

You're in charge of it.

[]

See itView everything we hold about you.

[]

Export itDownload your data and take it with you.

[]

Correct itFix anything that's wrong, any time.

[]

Delete itClose your account and we erase our copy.

This plain-language page is the one we actually live by. We keep only what a verified, member-owned community needs — your account, what you choose to post, and messages for a short window — each kept to a minimum and shared only if valid legal process requires it. Your verification proof isn't on that list: once we've confirmed you're a neighbor, it's gone. There's a full legal policy with the formal detail if you want it, and we're always glad to answer questions.

Full policy: steppe.community/legal/privacy Questions: Contact us The full legal policy is available in English, and the English version governs.

Steppe is a member-governed Oregon public benefit nonprofit. No owner. It can't be sold, and the mission is written into the articles. hello@steppe.community

ContactPrivacyTermsFor partners

Led by Greg Chism

REDMOND · CENTRAL OREGON · EST. 2026

/LEGAL/TERMS PAGE — rendered text Source: steppe/content/legal/terms.md (the page renders this markdown 1:1, stripping [CONFIRM ...] blockquotes) Added/aligned in commit 8f13a3f (2026-06-27). [CONFIRM ...] and [BRACKET] items are reviewer annotations for counsel, shown here on purpose. =====

Terms of Membership

Effective date: [EFFECTIVE DATE]
Version: Draft v1
Last updated: [LAST UPDATED]
Status: Draft (pending legal review)

Steppe is community-owned, ad-free civic infrastructure for Redmond, Central Oregon, operated by [LEGAL ENTITY]. These Terms of Membership govern your use of Steppe. A plain-language summary of how Steppe works lives across the site, and a companion Privacy Policy explains how we handle data; this document is the formal version. By becoming a member you agree to these terms.

[CONFIRM: Greg + counsel — confirm the controlling legal entity name and the governing-law / venue clause for an Oregon public benefit nonprofit.]

1. Membership and Verification

Membership is open to verified residents of [SERVICE AREA] who are at least [MINIMUM AGE]. Steppe is not anonymous: you prove once that you live here, and that gate is what keeps the community real.

A person reviews your proof of residency, and the proof is deleted the moment that check is made. We keep only that you are verified, the date, and the method — never an identity document, and never your legal name. To one another, members are known by a username (pseudonymous to peers). One account per member.

[CONFIRM: Greg + counsel — confirm the minimum membership age and the service area definition.]

2. Community Standards: A Two-Tier Model

What is and isn't allowed on Steppe lives in two layers.

Legal floor (not subject to member vote)

A short list of conduct is prohibited everywhere on Steppe and cannot be enabled by any member vote, because it reflects the law and the safety obligations of the organization:

- illegal goods or services;
- child sexual abuse material (CSAM) — reported to the NCMEC as required by law upon actual knowledge;
- non-consensual intimate imagery — removed through the process required by the TAKE IT DOWN Act;
- credible threats of violence;
- human trafficking or exploitation.

[CONFIRM: counsel — confirm the exact CSAM→NCMEC reporting procedure, the NCII takedown process and timelines, and the statutory citations to name here.]

Community norms (member-governed)

Everything above that floor — civility, harassment, the categories the marketplace may list, and similar standards — is set by the members through governance and recorded in the amendable Schedule of Defaults. Members decide the norms; members do not get to vote the legal floor away.

3. Moderation

Moderation is reactive and report-driven: members report content, human moderators review and decide, and the outcome is recorded in the public transparency log. A person — not an automated system — makes every consequential call.

We do not proactively monitor, scan, or filter your posts or your messages, and nothing here should be read as a promise to do so. Surfacing and sorting tools may help a moderator find a report faster, but they never decide. Removals may be appealed through the governance process.

4. The Marketplace / Exchange

Steppe hosts member listings — needs, offers, goods, jobs, mutual aid, and events.

- No on-platform payments. Steppe does not process, hold, or escrow money. Any transaction happens off-platform, directly between members, at their own arrangement and risk.
- Prohibited items. Listings may not offer anything on the legal floor in Section 2, nor anything on the member-governed prohibited-items list.
- Report a listing. Any member can report a listing; moderators act on reports as described in Section 3.

Steppe is not a party to transactions between members and makes no warranty about any listing, member, item, or service. Verified residency is the primary deterrent against bad-faith dealing.

5. Your Content

You keep ownership of what you post. You grant Steppe only the limited license needed to store and display your content to other members so the service works. You can delete your content, export your data, and leave at any time.

6. Data, Privacy, and Legal Process

How we handle data is set out in the Privacy Policy. In short, and as it bears on these terms:

- Verification evidence is deleted immediately after the residency check; we retain only the verified status, the date, and the method. Because we do not keep the proof, we cannot produce or disclose it — including under legal process.
- Messages and other member content are minimized and kept only for a limited window.
- We disclose member data only as required by valid legal process, and we can only ever produce what we actually hold. The scope of “we don’t keep it” is verification identity; we are honest that account details and content within their retention window do exist and may be subject to lawful disclosure.

7. Acceptable Use

Don’t break the law; don’t abuse, harass, endanger, or impersonate neighbors; don’t try to evade verification or moderation; and don’t scrape, overload, or attack the service.

8. Suspension and Termination

We may suspend or remove a member who violates the legal floor in Section 2 or, through the governance process, the community norms. You may leave at any time and we delete our copy of your data, except where an entry must remain in the append-only governance and transparency record.

[CONFIRM: counsel — reconcile member deletion with the append-only moderation/governance/audit record (what is scrubbed vs. what is retained as a tombstone).]

9. Disclaimers and Limitation of Liability

The service is provided “as is,” without warranties, to the fullest extent permitted by law. [LIABILITY LIMITATION CLAUSE]

[CONFIRM: counsel — supply the warranty disclaimer and liability-limitation language appropriate for an Oregon public benefit nonprofit.]

10. Governance and Changes to These Terms

The community-norms layer of these terms is amendable by member vote through the governance process; the legal floor in Section 2 is not. We will post any revised version here with a new effective date and, for material changes, give members notice in advance.

11. Contact

Questions about these terms can be sent to hello@steppe.community or by mail to [MAILING ADDRESS].

Decision Record — Trust & Safety, Verification Retention, and Minors-Version Governance

Date: 2026-06-27 **Status:** Adopted (canon). Supersedes prior verification-storage and T&S assumptions noted below. **Scope:** Policy and data-handling posture. Legal specifics flagged for counsel, not settled here. **Repo path:** docs/decisions/steppe-ts-verification-decision-record.md (filed under this name; the originally suggested trust-safety-verification-retention.md was not used)

Context

The anonymity / illegal-activity question surfaced a framing error worth correcting in canon: the platform's safety capability had been attributed to the *stored* verification record. It actually lives in the *gate* — requiring proof of residency to get in. Deterrence and Sybil suppression happen at the moment of verification, independent of whether the proof is kept afterward. Retaining raw evidence therefore added liability and an unmask capability without adding ongoing safety value. Deleting it immediately **dissolves** the “who can de-pseudonymize a member” problem rather than requiring it to be governed.

The guiding posture: Steppe is not anonymous — it is **pseudonymous to peers, verified at the gate, and identity-minimal in storage**.

Decisions

1. Verification retention — minimal by design

- Raw verification evidence is **deleted immediately** after the residency check. It is never a persistent store.
- The organization retains only: a **verified** flag, the verification date, and the method. No PII, no documents, no identity.
- This **supersedes** the prior “private verification-evidence storage bucket” treated as a durable store. If such a bucket exists, it becomes a transient, auto-purged review space only.
- “Immediately” means **actually purged** — gone from the transient review space and not lingering in database backups or audit logs. The audit log records the *fact* of a purge, never the evidence.

2. Ban-evasion / dedup token — deferred (primitive now, feature-later-by-vote)

- For launch, retain **nothing identity-derived**. A banned member can re-verify and return; among ~2,300 neighbors who know each other, that path is high-friction and socially visible.
- If ban-evasion becomes a **demonstrated** problem, members may vote to add a one-way, salted fingerprint of the residency proof — confirming “this identity already had an account” without revealing who. Escalate on evidence, not anticipation.

3. Two-tier trust & safety model

- **Legal floor (non-votable):** illegal goods/services, CSAM (mandatory NCMEC reporting on actual knowledge), non-consensual intimate imagery (TAKE IT DOWN Act takedown process), credible threats, trafficking. This is a compliance obligation of the legal entity — not a community norm.
- **Community norms (member-governed):** everything above the floor — civility, harassment, allowed marketplace categories — lives in the amendable Schedule of Defaults.

4. Moderation posture — reactive, human-scale

- Report-driven: members report, moderators act, decisions hit the transparency log.
- **No proactive content scanning.** Disproportionate at this scale and contrary to privacy-by-architecture; it is also the “moderation drifting toward a centralized staffed function” risk previously flagged.

5. Marketplace

- **No on-platform payments.** Neighbors transact off-platform; this keeps the org out of money-transmitter, escrow, and payment-liability territory.
- Pair with a prohibited-items list and report-a-listing. Verified identity is the primary deterrent.

6. Data minimization

- Short retention windows on chat / DMs. Minimizing retained data is both the privacy-protective and the liability/subpoena-exposure-reducing move — they point the same direction.

7. Terms & website copy — honest under-promising

- Public copy **describes and advertises** the real posture: we verify you’re a neighbor, then delete the proof; we hold no identity documents; we cannot disclose verification evidence we do not keep.
- The copy must not over-promise in either direction. Verification evidence: deleted immediately. Other data (account details, chat within its retention window): minimal, and disclosed only under valid legal process. The “we hold nothing” claim is **scoped to verification/identity, not all data**.
- Rationale: practice exceeds promise. Ninth-Circuit treatment (governs Oregon) can enforce a platform’s terms as duties, so under-promising is the safe posture.

8. Minors-only version — future member-vote item

- Whether to build a separate minors version is a **member vote**. The **safety floor is not votable** — members decide whether to build, not whether it’s safe.
- The vote must be **informed**: legal and operational cost, plus the non-negotiable floor (COPPA if under-13 is ever included, mandatory CSAM reporting, expanding state age-verification mandates), presented alongside the question. **Counsel review precedes any build**. This is the most legally-loaded feature on the roadmap.
- A *separate* minors app keeps adult↔minor DMs out of the main app entirely, removing the grooming surface.

Tradeoff accepted (knowingly)

This is the Signal / Apple posture: a subpoena for verification identity returns nothing because nothing is stored. The cost is that even in a genuine emergency — a credible threat traced to a member — the org cannot identify anyone from verification data. Adopted as a deliberate choice, not a side effect.

Supersedes

- “Private verification-evidence storage bucket” as a durable store → transient, auto-purged review space; retain only **verified** flag + date + method.
 - Any prior framing locating safety capability in the stored verification record → safety lives in the verification **gate**.
 - Current public website / terms copy implying retained verification information → to be re-aligned (see the privacy/terms alignment task).
-

Open / counsel items

- Oregon nonprofit exposure; exact CSAM→NCMEC and NCII procedures; precise terms language — bring this record **to** platform-liability counsel; it is the framework, not a substitute.
 - Confirm the actual verification code purges immediately before any copy advertises it (the alignment task’s Part 0 gate).
 - Watch the shifting Section 230 landscape (Graham-Durbin sunset bill on file for 2027).
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Changelog

- **2026-06-27** — Initial adoption.

Consent / Membership Agreement (documents table, v0.1) — rendered at /welcome read-and-confirm gate

Source: seed/documents-terms-privacy-v0.1.sql · DRAFT pending legal review · (retained-set enumeration aligned to include the date, 2026-07-08)

===== TERMS OF MEMBERSHIP (documents.kind = 'terms') =====

Terms of Membership

Draft v0.1 — pending Oregon legal review. This plain-language draft is written to be clear and protective, but it is not legal advice and has not yet been reviewed by an Oregon attorney. Bracketed items like [contact email] are placeholders to fill before publishing.

Our commitments, in one place

- **No advertising, ever.** You are the member, not the product. We don't run ads or build profiles to sell.
- **Your data is yours.** You can export it, and you can leave with it. We never sell it.
- **We verify, then forget.** Your residency documents are deleted as soon as we've checked them.
- **You govern this place.** Major decisions are made by member vote, and your ballot is secret.
- **Enforcement comes with a voice.** Any action against you can be appealed, and you're told why.
- **Fair, flat pricing.** One low flat price (free during the founding period) — and never raised without a member vote.

1 · What Steppe is

Steppe is community-owned digital civic infrastructure for the people of Redmond, Oregon. It is operated by [Steppe], an Oregon nonprofit public benefit corporation — member-governed, with no owner and a mission entrenched in its articles. It is **not** advertising-supported social media and is not built to be sold. By creating an account you agree to these Terms and to our Privacy Policy.

2 · Who can join

You must be **18 or older** to create an account at this time. Anyone may browse public information as a visitor. **Full participation** — creating events, RSVPing, posting, vouching, and voting — requires verifying that you are a Redmond resident (Section 3).

A version for ages 13-17 is planned for the future; it is not available yet and will launch only with its own protections and a community vote.

Why — the boundary that makes a commons work: verified residents only, plus a deliberate hold on minors until protections exist.

3 · Verifying your residency

To participate fully you agree to verify your Redmond residency through one of several pathways (for example a government ID, a utility bill, voter registration, a property record, or a one-time

code we mail to your address). A person reviews each submission. We may decline or revoke verification we reasonably believe to be inaccurate.

We delete your verification documents as soon as a decision is made. We keep only the fact that you are verified, the date, and which method you used — never the underlying documents (see Privacy, Section 3).

Why — verification that fits real people, plus verify-then-forget.

4 · Membership, tenure & your voice

Membership grows with participation: visitor → verified member → long-standing (tenured) member. The platform is governed by its members. Major decisions are made by community vote, and votes are weighted modestly by how long you've been a member, so newcomers have a real voice while established members carry proportionate weight. Certain core principles are **immutable** and can only change by a 75% supermajority after a 30-day deliberation period.

By participating in governance you agree that decisions properly made by community vote are binding on how the platform operates.

Why — tenure-weighted, capture-resistant governance.

5 · Being a good neighbor (acceptable use)

Steppe is a place for real neighbors to connect. You agree not to:

- harass, threaten, demean, or incite harm against others, or post hateful content;
- post content that is illegal, or use the platform to facilitate illegal activity;
- share others' private information (doxxing) or impersonate anyone;
- spam, advertise, or solicit commercially (commercial discovery lives with our partner, Redmond Compass);
- misrepresent your residency, create multiple or fake accounts, or evade verification or moderation;
- scrape, automate, overload, or attempt to break the platform or its security.

Specific community standards may be refined by the community over time; this list is the baseline.

6 · Moderation, consequences & appeals

Enforcement is graduated — typically a warning, then a temporary restriction, then a longer one, with serious cases going to review. **You can appeal any action taken against you**, and the appeal opens immediately. We will tell you what happened and why. No account is permanently removed without a review, and sustained member objection to a moderation decision can trigger a community vote to overturn it. Moderators are accountable to the same process.

Why — action-then-voice; no silent exit.

7 · Events & mutual aid are organized by members

Neighborhood events, gatherings, and (when available) mutual-aid posts are created and run by members, not by Steppe. We verify residency, but we do not otherwise vet members, and we are not a party to what members arrange. **Use good judgment and meet safely.** To the extent the law allows, Steppe is not responsible for members' conduct, statements, or in-person gatherings.

8 · Your content stays yours

You keep ownership of what you post. You grant Steppe a limited, non-exclusive license to store and display your content **only** as needed to operate the platform for the community — never to advertise, profile, or sell. You can export your content, and you can delete it; when you do, we remove it (some governance and moderation records may be kept in de-identified form for the integrity of the public record — see Privacy, Section 9).

Why — member-owned, non-extractive, exportable.

9 · Cost, and our promise on advertising

Steppe is funded by its members, never by advertising. **During the founding and beta period, membership is free.** When paid membership begins, it will be one low flat price; choosing a higher “supporter” amount funds others’ access, not extra features. **The price will never increase without a community vote**, and there will be no advertising, ever.

Why — price by means not scope; no-ads is structural and immutable.

10 · Leaving

You can close your account at any time and export your data first. We will delete your personal content, subject to the de-identified-record note above. We may suspend or close an account through the moderation process described in Section 6, with the right of appeal.

11 · Changes to these Terms

These Terms are versioned. If we change them, we will show you what changed and ask you to confirm the new version before you continue participating. Changes that affect governance or the immutable principles follow the community process in Section 4 — they are not made by the operator alone.

12 · Disclaimers & limits of liability

Steppe is provided “as is,” without warranties of any kind, to the fullest extent permitted by Oregon law. Any future emergency or community alerts are **best-effort and are never a substitute for 911 or official emergency sources**. To the extent the law allows, Steppe and its operators will not be liable for indirect or consequential damages, and total liability is limited to the amount you paid us in the prior 12 months (which, during the free period, is zero).

13 · Governing law & resolving disputes

These Terms are governed by the laws of the State of Oregon, and any dispute will be handled in the state or federal courts located in Deschutes County, Oregon. We ask that you first use the appeal and community-governance processes, and work with us informally, before pursuing a formal claim. (We do not require forced arbitration or waive your right to participate in class actions — keeping your options, and your voice, open.)

Why — dispute terms that don’t quietly strip member voice.

14 • Contact

Questions about these Terms: [contact email] • [mailing address]. [Steppe], Redmond, Oregon.

===== PRIVACY (documents.kind = 'privacy') =====

Privacy Policy

Draft v0.1 — pending Oregon legal review. This plain-language draft is not legal advice and has not yet been reviewed by an Oregon attorney. Bracketed items like [contact email] are placeholders to fill before publishing.

1 • The short version

We collect as little as possible, we never sell your data, and we run no advertising and no behavioral profiling. We don't use third-party ad trackers. What you create here is yours, and you can take it with you. The sections below are the detail behind those promises.

2 • What we collect

- **Account:** your email address (used to sign in).
- **Profile:** a display name, the neighborhood you choose, and your language preference.
- **Verification evidence:** whatever you submit to prove residency — kept only temporarily (Section 3).
- **What you create:** events, RSVPs, mutual-aid posts, proposals, and votes.
- **Minimal operational logs:** basic security and error logs needed to run the service safely.

3 • Verify, then forget

Verification documents are stored briefly in restricted storage, readable only by the people reviewing them, and **deleted automatically the moment your verification is approved or rejected**. Afterward we keep only three things: that you are verified, the date, and which method you used. We do not keep the documents themselves.

4 • Your votes are secret

How you vote on a proposal is private. Individual ballots are never shown to other members or to operators. Only the aggregate result and de-identified governance metadata are made public.

5 • Transparency & the public record

To keep the community accountable, we maintain an append-only log of governance and moderation actions and publish periodic transparency reports. These contain **aggregate information only — no personal data**.

6 • How we use your information

We use your information for one purpose: to operate Steppe and its governance — verifying residency, running events and votes, moderating fairly, and keeping the service secure. We **never** use it to advertise, to build profiles about you, or to sell.

7 • Who we share with

We do not sell or rent your data to anyone. We use a small number of service providers strictly to run the platform — currently our hosting and database provider (Supabase) and an email-delivery provider — under agreements that limit them to that purpose. We use no advertising networks. We disclose information to authorities only when legally required, and we will push back on requests that are overbroad.

8 • Cookies & analytics

We use only the essential cookies needed to keep you signed in and the service working. We do **not** use third-party advertising or cross-site tracking cookies. Any usage analytics are minimal, aggregate, and privacy-respecting.

9 • How long we keep things

We keep the minimum necessary. Verification evidence is deleted on decision (Section 3). Your content is kept while your account is active and removed when you delete it or close your account — except entries in the governance and moderation record, which may be retained in **de-identified** form so the public record stays intact.

10 • Your rights & choices

You can access and export your data, correct your profile, delete your content, close your account, and withdraw consent. Because data belongs to members, export is a first-class feature, not a favor. To make a request, use [contact / in-app data request]. (De-identified governance-record entries described in Section 9 may remain.)

11 • How we protect your information

Access to data is enforced at the database level (row-level security), staff and reviewer access is restricted to what's necessary, and we deliberately store as little as possible — the safest data is the data we never keep.

12 • Children

Steppe is for adults 18 and older at this time and is not directed to children under 13. A future version for ages 13-17 will have its own protections, will comply with applicable children's-privacy law (including COPPA), and will launch only after a community vote.

13 • Changes to this Policy

This Policy is versioned. If we make a material change, we will show you what changed and ask you to confirm before you continue.

14 • Contact

Privacy questions or data requests: [contact email] • [mailing address]. [Steppe], Redmond, Oregon.

STEPPE

A community-owned civic commons for Redmond and Central Oregon

Governance Charter & Bylaws

Working Draft v0.1

DRAFT — NOT YET ADOPTED. This is an internal working draft prepared for revision by the founder and review by qualified Oregon nonprofit counsel. It is not a legal instrument, not legal advice, and has no force until adopted under Article XII. Bracketed items and the punch list in Schedule A mark decisions still to be confirmed.

Field	Value
Entity	Steppe (Oregon nonprofit public benefit corporation)
Governing statute	ORS Chapter 65; intended Section 501(c)(3) status
Canon basis	Business Plan v11
Base dues	\$4 / month (flat)
Status	Working draft — for editing and legal review
Date	June 2026

Contents

Preamble

Steppe exists to give the people of Redmond and Central Oregon a piece of civic infrastructure they own together and cannot be sold out of. It is built on a simple wager: that a community can run its own shared space — its noticeboard, its calendar, its exchange, its conversation — without surrendering it to an attention economy that profits by extracting from the very people it claims to serve.

This Charter records how Steppe governs itself. It is written to make the organization's most important promises hard to break — entrenched in structure rather than in good intentions — while keeping the day-to-day life of the community flexible, reversible, and in the members' hands. Where this Charter constrains those who run Steppe, including its founder, that constraint is the point.

The provisions below are organized so that the load-bearing commitments — the things that make Steppe Steppe — are the hardest to change, and everything else can adapt as the community learns. *Ownership structure is destiny: a nonprofit with no owner, a locked mission, and a dissolution clause is not a detail to be revisited later but the foundation everything else rests on.*

Article I — Name, Legal Form, and Mission

1.1 Name

The name of the organization is Steppe (the “Organization” or “Steppe”).

1.2 Legal form

Steppe is organized as a nonprofit public benefit corporation under the Oregon Nonprofit Corporation Act, ORS Chapter 65, and is intended to qualify as a tax-exempt organization under Section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code. Steppe is a nonprofit from formation. It has no owners,

shareholders, or members holding any equity or ownership interest; membership confers governance and participation rights only, as set out in this Charter, and never a proprietary interest in the Organization or its assets.

Steppe cannot be sold, converted to a for-profit entity, or have its assets transferred for private benefit. Its mission and its non-distribution constraint are entrenched in its Articles of Incorporation and protected by Articles III, IX, and X of this Charter.

1.3 Mission

The mission of Steppe is to build and steward community-owned civic infrastructure for the residents of Redmond and the surrounding Central Oregon region — a verified, member-governed digital commons for local information, coordination, exchange, and connection — operated for the benefit of that community and never for the extraction of value from it.

1.4 Relationship of this Charter to the Articles of Incorporation

This Charter functions as the bylaws of the Organization. Where any provision of this Charter conflicts with the Articles of Incorporation or with applicable Oregon law, the Articles and the law control. Provisions designated as Entrenched Commitments (Article III) are intended to be mirrored in, and anchored by, the Articles of Incorporation.

Article II — Definitions

In this Charter, the following terms have the meanings given below.

Member — A natural person who has completed Residency Verification, paid current Dues (or holds an active Hardship Waiver), and has not been suspended or removed.

Member in Good Standing / Eligible Member — A Member whose Dues or Waiver is current and who is not under suspension; only Eligible Members may vote and count toward Quorum.

Service Area — The geographic area Steppe serves, initially the City of Redmond, Oregon, and such adjacent Central Oregon communities as the membership activates under Article XI.

Residency Verification — The mandatory process by which a person establishes residency in the Service Area before becoming a Member. It is an Entrenched Commitment (Article III).

Dues — The recurring membership fee set in Article VIII.

Board — The Board of Directors established under Article VI.

Director — A member of the Board.

Executive Director (ED) — The senior staff officer engaged under contract to operate Steppe (Article VII). The ED is an employee or contractor, not an owner.

Maintainer — A Member granted operational responsibility for a Group or feature, as defined in operating policy.

Moderator — A Member who performs community moderation and verification-review duties and may receive honoraria under Article VIII.

Quorum — The minimum participation required for a binding member vote (Article V).

Tenure Weight — The multiplier applied to an Eligible Member’s vote based on length of continuous membership (Article V).

Ordinary Decision — A routine governance or operating decision decided by simple majority of Eligible Members voting, without a Quorum or notice requirement beyond ordinary practice.

Major Policy — A decision requiring approval by 60% of the votes cast in a vote that meets Quorum (Article V).

Foundational Decision — A decision requiring approval by 75% of the votes cast in a vote that meets Quorum, following at least 30 days’ advance notice and deliberation (Article V).

Entrenched Commitment — One of the core promises listed in Article III, amendable only by Foundational Decision (or, where so anchored, not at all), and subject to the Founder Concurrence right during the Founder Protection Period.

Community Fund — The fund holding surplus and designated gifts, allocated annually by the membership through ranked-choice voting (Article VIII).

Member Access Fund — The fund that underwrites Hardship Waivers so that ability to pay never determines membership (Article VIII).

Voluntary Contribution — An optional member payment above Dues, directed by the member among permitted buckets (Article VIII).

Article III — Entrenched Commitments

The following commitments are the constitutional core of Steppe. They may be amended only by Foundational Decision under Article IX and, during the Founder Protection Period, only with Founder Concurrence under Article VII. Those anchored in the Articles of Incorporation (1.2, and the non-distribution and dissolution rules) are intended to be effectively immutable for the life of the Organization.

(a) No advertising, ever. Steppe will not sell advertising, sponsored placement, or attention. Its revenue comes from members, mission-aligned philanthropy, grants, and earned services — never from monetizing members’ attention or behavior.

(b) Mandatory residency verification. Participation is limited to verified residents of the Service Area. Steppe is a place, not an open platform; verification is a permanent condition of membership, not a growth lever to be relaxed.

(c) Community-controlled governance. Ultimate authority over Steppe rests with its members through the voting framework of Article V. No founder, director, staff member, funder, or outside party may acquire controlling authority over the Organization’s direction.

(d) Member-owned data. Members own their own data and content. Steppe acts as steward, not owner; it will not sell, license, or surveil member data, and members retain the right to export and to deletion as set out in operating policy.

(e) Reversible decisions. Governance is designed so that decisions can be revisited and undone by the same process that made them. Steppe favors reversible choices and preserves the community’s ability to change course.

(f) Surplus serves the community. No part of Steppe’s net earnings may inure to the benefit of any private individual. Operating surplus flows to the Community Fund and the mission, never to owners or insiders (Article VIII).

(g) Nonprofit form, no sale, locked mission. Steppe remains a nonprofit with no owner, cannot be sold or converted to private benefit, and on dissolution distributes its assets only to mission-aligned charitable successors (Articles I and X).

Article IV — Membership

4.1 Eligibility

Membership is open to any natural person who resides in the Service Area, completes Residency Verification, and meets the Dues obligation (or holds a Hardship Waiver). Membership is individual and non-transferable.

4.2 Residency verification

Each applicant must complete Residency Verification before being admitted. The verification process is administered by trained Moderators through Steppe’s verification-review process and is governed by privacy-protective operating policy. Verification evidence is **deleted immediately upon a verification decision**; the Organization retains only the verified status, the date, and the method — never the underlying documents or identity. During the brief review window the evidence is handled only within a restricted, auto-purged review space, and it is exempt from the no-images principle that otherwise applies to community content. This mirrors the Trust & Safety / Verification decision record and the public `/privacy` and `/legal/terms` copy.

4.3 Admission

An applicant becomes a Member upon successful verification and initiation of Dues or grant of a Hardship Waiver.

4.4 Rights of members

Each Member in Good Standing has the right to:

- vote on governance matters and stand for elected roles, subject to the framework of Article V;
- propose policies, candidates, and Community Fund allocations;
- access Steppe’s community features within the Service Area;
- own, export, and delete their own data and content;
- inspect the Organization’s governance records and financial statements consistent with radical transparency (Article VIII); and
- leave at any time and take their data with them (4.8).

4.5 Dues obligation

Membership requires current Dues as set in Article VIII, except where a Hardship Waiver applies. Ability to pay never determines eligibility.

4.6 Good standing, lapse, and reinstatement

A Member whose Dues lapse and who holds no Waiver moves out of Good Standing and may not vote until reinstated. Reinstatement is automatic on resumption of Dues or grant of a Waiver, with

no loss of accrued Tenure for the period of continuous membership preceding the lapse, subject to operating policy on extended lapses.

4.7 Suspension and removal

A Member may be suspended or removed only for conduct that violates Steppe’s community standards or this Charter, and only through a process that provides notice, an opportunity to respond, and a right of appeal to the Board. Suspension and removal procedures are set in operating policy and must conform to the due-process principle stated here. Removal does not extinguish a former Member’s data-export and deletion rights.

4.8 Voluntary departure and data portability

Any Member may resign at any time. On departure, the Member retains the right to export their data and to have their personal data deleted, consistent with Article III(d). Exit is a protected right; Steppe will not erect penalties or friction to discourage it.

Article V — Member Governance and Voting

5.1 Principle of member governance

Steppe is governed by its members. Elected and appointed roles exist to serve the membership and operate within the authority the members delegate; they do not displace member control over the Organization’s direction (Article III(c)).

5.2 Decision tiers

Decisions are sorted into three tiers by their stakes. Higher-stakes decisions require broader agreement and more deliberation.

Tier	Threshold	Typical matters
Ordinary Decision	Simple majority of Eligible Members voting	Routine operating and policy choices not reserved to a higher tier
Major Policy	60% of votes cast, Quorum met	Significant policy changes, budgets, dues decreases, board recall
Foundational Decision	75% of votes cast, Quorum met, 30-day notice	Amending Entrenched Commitments, dues increases, dissolution, changing Article IX

5.3 Quorum

A binding Major Policy or Foundational vote requires a Quorum of at least 15% of Eligible Members participating. Ordinary Decisions do not carry a separate Quorum requirement beyond ordinary practice.

5.4 Tenure-weighted voting

To reward sustained commitment to the community without entrenching a permanent class, each Eligible Member’s vote is weighted by length of continuous membership, on the following brackets. Weighting is bounded at 3×; no member’s vote may exceed three times a new member’s vote.

Continuous membership	Vote weight
Less than 1 year	1.0×
1 year to under 2 years	1.5×
2 years to under 4 years	2.0×
4 years and over	3.0×

5.5 Secret ballot

Member votes are cast by secret ballot. Ballots are confidential before and after a vote closes; the system is designed so that no administrator, director, or founder can link a member to their ballot. Only aggregate results and the fact of participation are recorded.

5.6 Ranked-choice for allocations

Allocations among competing options — including annual Community Fund allocation — are decided by ranked-choice voting, so that outcomes reflect the membership's ordered preferences rather than a plurality.

5.7 Proposal process

Any Member in Good Standing may bring a proposal, subject to a sponsorship or signature threshold set in operating policy to prevent flooding. Proposals state their tier, the exact change sought, and their reversibility. Foundational proposals require at least 30 days of notice and open deliberation before the vote opens. Voting windows are fixed in advance and may not be shortened once opened.

5.8 Reversibility

Consistent with Article III(e), a decision may be revisited and reversed by a later vote of the same tier. No vote may be structured to make its own reversal harder than its adoption, except where this Charter expressly assigns asymmetric protection (as in Article VIII dues).

5.9 Record and audit

Results of all binding votes are recorded in an immutable, tamper-evident audit record. Governance records are open to member inspection. The integrity of the audit record is a system-level guarantee and may not be overridden by any role.

Article VI — Board of Directors

6.1 Role

The Board stewards the mission, oversees the Executive Director, safeguards the Entrenched Commitments, and exercises the fiduciary duties Oregon law places on directors of a public benefit corporation. The Board serves the membership and operates within member-set policy.

6.2 Composition and size

The Board consists of [5–9] Directors, the exact number fixed by operating policy within that range. A majority must be Members in Good Standing. The Board includes the founder's seat as provided in 6.8 and observes the founding-cohort diversity commitments adopted by the membership.

6.3 Election and terms

Directors are elected by the membership under Article V to staggered terms of [two/three] years, so that no single election replaces the entire Board. Terms, term limits, and nomination procedures are set in operating policy consistent with this Charter.

6.4 Recall

Any Director may be recalled before the end of their term by a Major Policy vote (60% of votes cast, Quorum met). The founder's transition to an advisory seat under 6.8 is governed by Article VII, not by ordinary recall.

6.5 Powers and limits

The Board may act on all matters not reserved to the membership. It may not amend or override an Entrenched Commitment, authorize advertising, approve a sale or conversion of the Organization, distribute net earnings to any private person, or exceed the funder-concentration and compensation limits of Articles VII and VIII. Powers reserved to the membership remain with the membership.

6.6 Meetings and transparency

The Board meets on a regular schedule. Minutes, decisions, and financial oversight materials are made available to members consistent with the radical-transparency standard of Article VIII, subject only to narrow confidentiality for personnel, legal, and verification-privacy matters.

6.7 Conflicts of interest

Directors must disclose actual and potential conflicts of interest and recuse themselves from affected decisions. Relationships between Directors and entities that contract with Steppe — including the founder’s outside consulting work — must be disclosed and managed under a written conflict-of-interest policy.

6.8 Founder’s board seat and transition

The founder holds a Director seat during the Founder Protection Period. At or before the end of that Period, the founder’s seat converts to a permanent, non-voting advisory seat, as detailed in Article VII. The transition is a structural feature of this Charter, not a discretionary act of the Board.

Article VII — Executive Director and Founder Protection

7.1 Executive Director

The Executive Director operates Steppe day-to-day under the Board’s oversight, pursuant to a contract. The ED is an employee or contractor of the Organization and holds no ownership interest of any kind. The role exists to serve the mission and the membership.

7.2 Founding Executive Director

The founder may serve as the Founding Executive Director under contract. This role is compensated service, not ownership or control. Nothing in the founder’s role diminishes the membership’s ultimate authority under Article III(c).

7.3 Compensation framework

Executive Director compensation is bounded and transparent. It moves through phases tied to the Organization’s capacity, with a hard ceiling set deliberately below comparable academic and market salaries as a signal of public trust.

Phase	Annual compensation
Founding / pre-revenue	\$0 (volunteer)
Early operations	\$15,000 – \$25,000 stipend
Sustained operations	\$95,000 ceiling (hard cap)

Cost-of-living adjustments to the ceiling are capped at 3% annually. Any increase above the ceiling, or any change to this framework, is a Major Policy decision and must be disclosed under Article VIII.

7.4 Founder Protection Period

To protect the integrity of the mission during Steppe’s formative years, a Founder Protection Period runs from adoption of this Charter for [five to seven] years and then sunsets automatically. The exact length is fixed at adoption and may not be extended except by Foundational Decision.

7.5 Founder Concurrence right (negative power only)

During the Founder Protection Period, the following actions require the founder’s concurrence in addition to the otherwise-required member or Board approval:

- amending or repealing an Entrenched Commitment (Article III);
- dissolving, merging, or selling the Organization or substantially all of its assets (Article X); and
- lowering the amendment thresholds of Article IX, including this concurrence right itself.

This is a negative power only. The founder may withhold concurrence to block one of the listed changes, but may not use it to compel any action, direct ordinary governance, override a member or Board decision outside the listed set, or otherwise exercise positive control. It is not a general veto, not an ownership interest, and not a controlling authority within the meaning of Article III(c).

7.6 Sunset and transition to advisory

At the end of the Founder Protection Period, the Concurrence right expires permanently and the founder’s Director seat converts to a permanent, non-voting advisory seat (6.8). The sunset is automatic and self-executing; no vote is required to end the Period, and the Period may be extended only by Foundational Decision before it lapses.

Legal-review flag. A founder concurrence right inside a member-governed nonprofit with no owner sits in tension with the no-controlling-authority principle (Article III(c)) and with Oregon nonprofit governance norms. Counsel must structure this as a narrow, time-limited reserved power in the bylaws and confirm it is compatible with ORS Chapter 65 and 501(c)(3), or propose an alternative mechanism that achieves mission protection without conferring control. See Schedule A.

Article VIII — Dues, Funds, and Finances

8.1 Dues

Base Dues are \$4 per month (flat), the same for every Member regardless of means. To minimize payment-processing cost, Dues are billed annually or by ACH where practicable. The flat price reflects Steppe’s commitment to one fair price near cost, never a fee scaled to what a member can be made to pay.

8.2 Asymmetric dues protection

Changes to base Dues are deliberately protected asymmetrically: raising the price is hard, lowering it is easier. This makes the member-affordability promise structurally difficult to erode while keeping relief easy to grant.

Change to base Dues	Required process
Increase	Foundational Decision — 75% of votes cast, Quorum met, 30-day notice
Decrease	Major Policy — 60% of votes cast, Quorum met

8.3 Hardship Waiver

Any Member may receive a Hardship Waiver of Dues on request, without documentation and without inquiry into their circumstances. Waivers are funded by the Member Access Fund. A Member on Waiver is a full Member in Good Standing with full voting rights.

8.4 Voluntary Contribution layer

Above base Dues, Members may make optional Voluntary Contributions and direct each contribution among three buckets: (i) unrestricted operations, (ii) the Member Access Fund, and (iii) the Community Fund. Contributions are never required and never affect a Member's standing or rights.

8.5 Member Access Fund

The Member Access Fund underwrites Hardship Waivers so that ability to pay never determines membership (Article III). It is replenished by designated Voluntary Contributions and, as the Board directs, by operating surplus.

8.6 Community Fund

Operating surplus and gifts designated to it flow to the Community Fund. Each year the membership allocates the Community Fund among community priorities by ranked-choice vote (Article V). Allocation is collective: no individual may earmark a Community Fund gift to a specific recipient, and the Organization makes no individual charity designations on members' behalf.

8.7 Funding model and concentration limit

Steppe is funded by five streams: member Dues (the anchor of core operations), philanthropic donations, foundation grants, government funding (anticipated from 2028), and earned revenue from mission-aligned services. To preserve independence, no single funder may provide more than 30% of annual operating revenue.

8.8 Surplus and non-distribution

Steppe operates on a non-distribution constraint. No part of its net earnings may inure to the benefit of any Director, officer, ED, Member, or other private individual. Surplus serves the mission through the Community Fund and the Member Access Fund (Article III(f)).

8.9 Moderator honoraria

Active Moderators may receive honoraria of \$50–\$100 per month in recognition of their labor. Total Moderator honoraria are capped at 8% of operating expenses. **[Amendment pending — see Operating Budget §4: the flat 8%-of-opex cap cannot fund the promised three-moderator floor at early stages; to be amended to “the greater of the \$1,800/yr floor or 8% of core opex, capped at \$100/mo/moderator, grant-funded until Stage 2.”]** Moderators serve staggered, one-year renewable terms, with a minimum of three active Moderators to preserve plural judgment and prevent capture.

8.10 Financial transparency

Steppe practices radical financial transparency. It publishes its budget, financial statements, funder breakdown, compensation against the Article VII framework, and Community Fund allocations to its members on a regular cadence, subject only to narrow privacy exceptions.

Article IX — Amendments

9.1 Tiered amendment

This Charter is amended through the same tiered framework that governs all Steppe decisions (Article V). The tier required depends on what is being changed.

9.2 Matters requiring a Foundational Decision

The following may be changed only by Foundational Decision (75% of votes cast, Quorum met, 30-day notice):

- any Entrenched Commitment (Article III);
- an increase to base Dues (Article VIII);
- the compensation ceiling framework or Founder Protection provisions (Article VII);
- this Article IX, including any change to amendment thresholds; and
- dissolution, merger, or sale (Article X).

All other policy amendments are Major Policy or Ordinary Decisions according to their stakes.

9.3 Notice and deliberation

Foundational amendments require at least 30 days of advance notice and open deliberation before voting opens, so that the membership can consider them fully.

9.4 Founder Concurrence during the Protection Period

During the Founder Protection Period, amendments within the scope of Article 7.5 additionally require Founder Concurrence. This requirement itself sunsets with the Period.

9.5 Limits on amendment

No amendment may reduce an amendment threshold except by meeting that same threshold; no amendment may remove the non-distribution constraint or the dissolution rule, which are anchored in the Articles of Incorporation; and no amendment may confer ownership of, or controlling authority over, the Organization on any person (Article III(c)).

Article X — Dissolution

10.1 Process

Steppe may be dissolved only by Foundational Decision and in accordance with ORS Chapter 65 and applicable federal tax law. During the Founder Protection Period, dissolution also requires Founder Concurrence (Article 7.5).

10.2 Distribution of assets

On dissolution, after satisfying liabilities, Steppe's remaining assets must be distributed exclusively to one or more organizations that are exempt under Section 501(c)(3) and whose purposes are consistent with Steppe's mission, as the membership directs. No asset may be distributed to any Member, Director, officer, ED, or other private person.

10.3 Mission lock

This dissolution rule and the non-distribution constraint are anchored in the Articles of Incorporation and are not amendable in a manner that would permit private benefit. They are the ultimate guarantee that Steppe cannot be captured or cashed out.

Article XI — Regional Expansion (Deferred Activation)

11.1 Subsidiarity

Steppe is built to grow into a federation of local commons across Central Oregon without becoming centralized. Decisions that affect only one town are made by that town's members; only genuinely regional matters rise to a regional vote. Local control is the default.

11.2 Structural principles locked now

The structural principles of regional governance are adopted now and may be changed only by Foundational Decision: (a) subsidiarity scope tiers that keep local decisions local; and (b) a dual-majority requirement for regional decisions, so that a measure must carry both an overall majority and a majority within each affected town.

11.3 Numeric dials deferred

The specific numeric parameters of regional governance — tier boundaries, dual-majority percentages, and representation formulas — are deferred and will be ratified by the membership once Steppe has active members in two or more qualifying towns. Until then, this Article states principle only and is not operative as to numbers.

Article XII — Adoption, Effective Date, and Review

12.1 Adoption

This Charter takes effect when adopted by the founding membership in accordance with the Articles of Incorporation and, pending a founding membership vote, when approved by the initial Board. Until adoption, it has no binding force.

12.2 Effective date

The effective date is the date of adoption recorded below, which also begins the Founder Protection Period (Article VII).

12.3 Periodic review

The Board will place this Charter before the membership for review at least once every [three] years, so that the community can confirm or revise it through the normal amendment process.

12.4 Severability

If any provision of this Charter is held invalid or unenforceable, the remaining provisions continue in effect, and the invalid provision is reformed to the minimum extent necessary to be valid while preserving its intent.

12.5 Governing law

This Charter is governed by the laws of the State of Oregon and must be read consistently with the Articles of Incorporation, ORS Chapter 65, and the requirements of Section 501(c)(3).

Adopted on: _____

Founding Executive Director

Board Chair, on behalf of the Board of Directors

Schedule A — Open Drafting Questions & Legal-Review Flags

This schedule is not part of the operative Charter. It is a working punch list of items to confirm before adoption and to raise with Oregon nonprofit counsel.

Decisions to confirm (bracketed in the text)

- Founder Protection Period length: fix the exact term within five to seven years (7.4).
- Board size and term length: confirm the 5–9 range and term/stagger (6.2, 6.3).
- Charter review cadence: confirm the review interval (12.3).
- Proposal sponsorship/signature thresholds: set in operating policy (5.7).

Legal-review flags for counsel

- Founder Concurrence right (7.5): confirm a narrow, time-limited negative reserved power is enforceable under ORS Chapter 65 and compatible with 501(c)(3) and with the no-controlling-authority commitment (III(c)); or propose an alternative mission-protection mechanism.
- Entrenchment mechanics: confirm which commitments belong in the Articles of Incorporation versus the bylaws, and how to make the Article III set genuinely hard to amend under Oregon law.
- Asymmetric dues protection (8.2): confirm a bylaws-level supermajority-to-raise / majority-to-lower rule is enforceable and consistent with member-rights provisions.
- Tenure-weighted voting (5.4): confirm weighted member voting is permissible for an Oregon public benefit corporation with members and is reflected correctly in the Articles.
- Compensation ceiling (7.3): confirm the framework satisfies reasonable-compensation and private-inurement rules; document the basis.
- Dissolution and non-distribution (Article X): confirm the asset-distribution clause meets 501(c)(3) requirements.

Not legal advice. This document was prepared as a working draft to support the founder's editing and a subsequent review by qualified Oregon nonprofit counsel. It does not constitute legal advice and creates no rights or obligations until properly adopted.

Steppe — Conflict of Interest Register

Document: Conflict of Interest Register **Version:** v2 **Status:** Active **Maintained by:** Founding Executive Director; reviewed by the Board **Last updated:** 2026-07-08

Purpose and scope

This register is the canonical record of disclosed conflicts and related-party relationships affecting Steppe’s directors, officers, and staff. It operationalizes Steppe’s Conflict of Interest Policy [policy reference — TBD; the policy itself is not yet in the counsel packet] and sits alongside the recusal provisions in the governing documents. A relationship is recorded here whether or not Steppe is a party to it: a private commercial relationship between two directors, or a family relationship between a director and a Steppe counterparty, is disclosable on its own terms because it can bear on board independence.

Standing recusals

- **Cobb — Redmond Compass.** Director Holli Cobb (owner, Redmond Compass) recuses from any Steppe-Redmond Compass organizational matter, **and from any matter in which Mr. Chism or his entities have a financial interest** (see Entry 001).
- **Weimer — Herringbone Books.** Should Steppe and Herringbone Books ever enter a paid arrangement, Director Brandon Weimer recuses from any board matter touching it. Ordinary platform membership is not a conflict.
- **Weimer — Ignite Empowerment Foundation (fiscal sponsor).** Director Weimer is the spouse of IEF’s founder; he recuses from every Steppe-IEF matter (see Entry 002).
- **Chism — own compensation & entities.** Director/ED Gregory Chism recuses from setting his own compensation and from any matter in which Sunbreak LLC or Three Canyon Consulting LLC has a financial interest, **including matters involving Redmond Compass or Ms. Cobb** (see Entry 001).

[COUNSEL] Confirm which recusals (if any) belong in the Articles of Incorporation versus the Conflict of Interest Policy / bylaws. Entrenching individual, person-specific recusals in the Articles is rigid (directors change; Articles amendment is heavy); the policy/register layer is usually the better home.

Register index

#	Party	Relationship	Steppe a party?	Disclosed	Status
001	Greg Chism / Three Canyon Consulting LLC ↔ Redmond Compass (Director Cobb)	Paid commercial engagement between the ED’s LLC and a fellow director’s company	No	2026-06-26 (confirmed 2026-07-08)	Active; board review pending

#	Party	Relationship	Steppe a party?	Disclosed	Status
002	Director Brandon Weimer ↔ Ignite Em- powerment Foundation (Steppe's fiscal sponsor)	Director is the spouse of the fiscal sponsor's founder	Yes (Steppe-IEF sponsorship)	2026-07-08	Active; board review pending

Entries

001 — Three Canyon Consulting Redmond Compass

- **Disclosing person:** Greg Chism, Founding Executive Director and director.
- **Nature:** Mr. Chism, through **Three Canyon Consulting LLC** (confirmed 2026-07-08 as the holding entity), holds a commercial engagement providing application-development services to **Redmond Compass**, whose founder, Holli Cobb, is a Steppe director. The engagement is at market rate under written contract.
- **Steppe involvement:** None. Steppe is not a party and contributes no funds, assets, or staff time.
- **Why recorded:** Two Steppe directors hold a private commercial relationship in which funds flow from a director's company (Redmond Compass) to the ED's LLC (Three Canyon). This creates an **indirect financial relationship** between Mr. Chism and Ms. Cobb: **neither is disinterested as to the other**, and neither may approve the other's interested-person transactions or the other's matters (including ED compensation, for Ms. Cobb).
- **Interaction with the no-Steppe-client rule:** The engagement is the one existing exception to Three Canyon's commitment to take no Steppe-related clients; going forward Three Canyon takes no **new** such clients, and Mr. Chism has committed to wind this engagement down (COI Disclosure Packet, Part 3, item 7).
- **Recusal terms (board-adopted):**
 - Director Chism recuses from any Steppe decision involving Redmond Compass or Ms. Cobb's businesses, and from setting his own compensation.
 - Director Cobb recuses from any Steppe decision involving Mr. Chism or his entities, including ED compensation, and from Redmond Compass matters.
 - The engagement is a private commercial matter conducted at arm's length, creating no Steppe obligation.
- **Engagement start date:** *[TBD — supply for the record]*
- **Disclosed:** 2026-06-26 · **Facts confirmed by ED:** 2026-07-08 · **Board reviewed:** *[pending]*

002 — Director Weimer Ignite Empowerment Foundation (fiscal sponsor)

- **Disclosing person:** Brandon Weimer, director (and, as needed, the ED on the organization's behalf).
- **Nature:** Director Weimer is the **spouse of the founder of Ignite Empowerment Foundation (IEF)**, which is **Steppe's confirmed fiscal sponsor** (sponsorship agreement pending signature). Under the arrangement, IEF holds and re-grants Steppe-directed funds and charges an administrative fee.
- **Steppe involvement:** Yes — Steppe is a party to the fiscal-sponsorship relationship with IEF.

- **Why recorded:** A family relationship between a Steppe director and the fiscal sponsor's founder bears directly on board independence and makes the Steppe-IEF relationship (agreement, admin fee, fund flows, transition off sponsorship) an **interested-person / related-party matter**. It also means Director Weimer — otherwise the board's most independent member relative to the Chism-Cobb conflict — is **not** a clean, universally disinterested director.
- **Recusal terms (board-adopted):**
 - Director Weimer recuses from any board deliberation or vote on the fiscal-sponsorship agreement, the sponsor administrative fee, fund transfers to or from IEF, or the transition off sponsorship, and is not counted toward the quorum approving them.
 - The Steppe-IEF terms are approved by the disinterested directors on arm's-length terms and documented contemporaneously.
 - Director Weimer remains available to serve as a disinterested approver of matters unrelated to IEF (e.g., ED compensation, Redmond Compass matters), subject to the board-composition note below.
- **Board-composition note:** With Chism, Cobb, and Weimer each carrying a disclosed relationship, **no current director is free of every conflict**. Steppe plans to **seat a fourth, fully independent director** to provide a clean, plural disinterested body for the most sensitive approvals.
- **Disclosed:** 2026-07-08 · **Board reviewed:** *[pending]*

Board actions log

Date	Action	Reference
2026-06-26	ED disclosed the Three Canyon-Redmond Compass engagement; entered as #001.	Entry 001
2026-07-08	ED confirmed #001 is held by Three Canyon Consulting LLC and is a current, arm's-length engagement to be wound down; COI Disclosure Packet updated to v1.4.	Entry 001
2026-07-08	Weimer-IEF spousal relationship disclosed; IEF confirmed as fiscal sponsor; entered as #002.	Entry 002
<i>[pending]</i>	Board received disclosures 001 and 002, confirmed recusal terms, and (re)confirmed the composition of the disinterested approving body; noted the plan to seat a fourth independent director.	Minute <i>[ref]</i>

Board minute (ready to enter)

The board received the ED's confirmation that the disclosed Three Canyon Consulting engagement with Redmond Compass (founder, Director Cobb) is held by Three Canyon and is a current arm's-length engagement to be wound down (Entry 001), and the disclosure that Director Weimer is the spouse of the founder of Ignite Empowerment Foundation, Steppe's fiscal sponsor (Entry 002). The board confirmed the recusal terms recorded in the register, noted that no current director is free of every conflict, and recorded the plan to seat a fourth, fully independent director to constitute

a disinterested approving body for compensation and interested-person transactions.
No Steppe resources are involved in the Three Canyon engagement.

Changelog

- **v2 (2026-07-08):** Entry 001 updated (Three Canyon confirmed as the holding entity; indirect Chism-Cobb financial relationship and mutual recusal recorded). Entry 002 added (Weimer ↔ IEF fiscal-sponsor spousal relationship). Standing recusals expanded (Weimer-IEF; Chism-own entities/comp; Cobb-Chism matters). Counsel flag added on Articles-vs-policy entrenchment.
- **v1 (2026-06-26):** Register created. Standing recusals referenced from the Articles. Entry 001 (Three Canyon ↔ Redmond Compass) added; board review pending.

Steppe — Proposed Operating Budget (staged)

v1 • July 2026 • PROPOSED — planning numbers, not commitments. Living document: the founding cohort and board ratify or amend these figures; update at each stage gate and whenever a real invoice replaces an estimate. Companion to Business Plan v12 (§04 revenue ladder, §07 dues, §08 stewards) and the Funder Eligibility Reference v3. Fiscal sponsor: **Ignite Empowerment Foundation (IEF) — confirmed**; the sponsorship agreement is pending signature and the sponsor admin fee below is a planning placeholder until it is signed. **Related-party note:** Director Brandon Weimer is the spouse of IEF's founder, so the Steppe-IEF terms (admin fee, fund flows) are an interested-person matter, to be approved by the disinterested directors with Mr. Weimer recused (COI Register, Entry 002).

Purpose. BP v12 asserts “dues alone carry core operations at every rung” but no document derived it. This table makes the claim checkable — and it surfaces the one place the current policy arithmetic doesn't close (moderator honoraria; see §4).

1 • The stages (from Business Plan v12)

Stage	Members	Dues revenue (@ \$4/mo flat)	Period (planning)
0 • Prototype / closed beta	0 paying (cohort is free)	\$0	2026
1 • Public launch base	200	\$9,600/yr	late 2026 → 2027
2 • First plateau	500	\$24,000/yr	2027
3 • Growth	1,000	\$48,000/yr	2027-28
4 • Comp-ceiling threshold	~2,300	~\$110,000/yr	2028+

2 • Annual operating costs by stage (planning numbers)

Core = what dues must carry (the survivability rule). Program = grant-fundable, never load-bearing.

Line (annual)	Stage 0	Stage 1 (200)	Stage 2 (500)	Stage 3 (1,000)	Stage 4 (~2,300)	Basis
CORE						
Hosting & infra (Supabase, host, domain, DNS)	\$600	\$900	\$1,200	\$1,800	\$3,000	Supabase Pro ≈\$300; host plan grows with traffic; Package A's year-one \$1,500 line is grant-covered free tier → paid as volume grows
Transactional email (Resend)	\$0	\$240	\$240	\$480	\$700	Package A funds year one (\$1,500); renewals are core
D&O insurance	\$0 ¹	\$1,500	\$1,500	\$1,600	\$1,800	

Line (annual)	Stage 0	Stage 1 (200)	Stage 2 (500)	Stage 3 (1,000)	Stage 4 (~2,300)	Basis
State/IRS compliance (OR DOJ CT-12, 990-N→990-EZ, registered agent)	\$100	\$300	\$500	\$1,200	\$2,000	990-N free ≤\$50K gross; CPA-prepared 990-EZ from Stage 3
Payment processing on dues (~4% planning; annual/ACH billing)	\$0	\$400	\$960	\$1,900	\$4,400	2.9%+30¢ card on \$48/yr ≈3.5%; ACH cheaper — 4% is conservative
Misc (tools, print, tabling)	\$150	\$250	\$400	\$600	\$1,000	
Core subtotal	\$850	\$3,590	\$4,800	\$7,580	\$12,900	
Dues cover core?	n/a (no dues)	YES — 2.7×	YES — 5.0×	YES — 6.3×	YES — 8.5×	the BP claim, now derived
PROGRAM / POLICY (grant- or surplus-funded)						
Moderator honoraria (3 stewards; see §4)	\$0 (volunteer)	\$1,800 ²	\$1,920 ³	\$3,600	\$3,600	floor 3×\$50/mo; cap per §4 resolution
Moderator training	\$1,000 ²	\$500	\$500	\$750	\$1,000	Package A year one
Legal (formation year one; then episodic)	\$3,000 ²	\$500	\$750	\$1,000	\$1,500	Package A funds the \$3,000
Bilingual access / a11y program	grant	grant	grant	grant	grant	never core, per BP
Sponsor admin fee (only while fiscally sponsored; on sponsor-routed funds)	8% of grants ²	8%	— (own 501(c)(3))	—	—	placeholder until the IEF agreement fixes the rate
ED compensation (ceiling \$95K)	\$0	\$0	\$0	partial, if board approves	at ceiling only at ~2,300	BP v12 §04; academic income carries the founder until the salary is demonstrated

¹ Stage 0 has no insurable operations until launch; bind D&O at first public launch. ² Grant-funded in year one via the Package A lines (MasterCase §05): hosting \$1,500, D&O \$1,500, legal \$3,000, moderator training \$1,000, sponsor admin 8%. ³ See §4 — the current 8%-of-opex cap cannot fund even the floor at early stages.

3 · Revenue recap against the stages

Source	Stage 0	1	2	3	4
Dues (\$4/mo flat, hardship waiver via Member Access Fund)	\$0	\$9.6K	\$24K	\$48K	~\$110K
Founding Supporters (one-time, launch)	\$5-10K goal	—	—	—	—
Foundation grants (Roundhouse ≤\$2.5K small / ≤\$30K Open Call per FE v3; OCF \$15-20K typical; Ford Family ≤\$25K w/ 25% match; Bend Fdn; Deschutes Cultural \$1-3K)	pipeline	pipeline	pipeline	tapering	episodic
Government (2028+, ≤25% of revenue, infrastructure only)	—	—	—	—	fenced
Earned (visitor listing fees, replication support)	—	—	—	unnumbered until a counterparty exists	”

Guardrails that bind this budget: **no single funder >30%** (§5 of the funding strategy needs a ramp rule for 2026-27 — flagged there); **dues fund core, always**; government money never core.

4 · The honoraria arithmetic — resolution (needs Charter §8.9 amendment)

Current policy: \$50-100/month per moderator, three-moderator minimum (BP §08; Charter 8.9), **capped at 8% of operating expenses**. The floor ($3 \times \$50 \times 12 = \$1,800/\text{yr}$) is only permitted by the cap at $\text{opex} \geq \$22,500/\text{yr}$ — which no early stage reaches. As written, the policy cannot pay the minimum it promises.

Resolution (adopted as this budget’s planning basis; requires board/cohort ratification and a matching amendment to Charter §8.9): honoraria = **the greater of the \$1,800/yr floor or 8% of core opex**, hard-capped at \$100/mo/moderator, and **grant-funded until Stage 2** (own-determination + \$24K dues), after which dues surplus may carry it. This keeps stewards paid from day one without breaching the dues-cover-core rule. **Charter §8.9 (the flat 8%-of-opex cap) must be amended to this rule so the two documents agree** — flagged in the review annex and noted at §8.9.

5 • Deliberately not specified here

No five-year pro-forma, no month-level cash-flow, no audited-statement theater — the plan's discipline is its credibility. This document stays one page of derivable numbers; the next revision replaces estimates with actuals as invoices land (hosting, IEF fee, insurance quote) and records the honoraria ratification.

Changelog - v1.1 (2026-07-08) — fiscal sponsor confirmed as Ignite Empowerment Foundation with a related-party note (Director Weimer is the spouse of IEF's founder); honoraria fix adopted as the planning basis and flagged for a matching Charter §8.9 amendment. - v1 (2026-07-04) — first derivation; created from the strategy audit's finding that no operating budget existed anywhere in the doc set.

Steppe — Schedule of Defaults

Document: Schedule of Defaults (member-governed community norms) **Version:** Working Draft v0.1 **Status:** DRAFT — not yet ratified. Initial defaults to be confirmed by the founding cohort and reviewed by counsel. **Canonical repo path (suggested):** docs/Steppe-Schedule-of-Defaults-v0.1.md **Governing instruments:** Governance Charter & Bylaws (Article V, Article III); Terms of Membership §2 (two-tier model); Trust & Safety / Verification decision record §3. **Last updated:** 2026-07-08

What this is. This Schedule holds the **community norms** — the layer of “what is and isn’t allowed on Steppe” that the members govern. It is the amendable companion to the **non-votable legal floor** in Terms of Membership §2. Members set, and may change, everything in this Schedule through the governance process; members do **not** get to vote the legal floor away.

Amendment. Unless a specific item states otherwise, this Schedule is amended by **Major Policy vote** (60% of votes cast, quorum met) under Charter Article V. Any item that would touch an Entrenched Commitment (Charter Article III) requires a **Foundational Decision** (75% + 30-day notice) instead. Changes are versioned and recorded in the governance log.

Not legal advice; draft. Bracketed items are decisions for the founding cohort. This draft is written to be clear and enforceable and is pending counsel review.

0. How to read this Schedule

- **The legal floor comes first and is not here.** Conduct on the non-votable legal floor — illegal goods/services, CSAM, non-consensual intimate imagery, credible threats of violence, human trafficking or exploitation — is prohibited everywhere on Steppe regardless of anything in this Schedule, and is defined in Terms of Membership §2. This Schedule never overrides, narrows, or re-enables anything on that floor.
- **Everything in this Schedule is member-governed.** It can be proposed, debated, and changed by members under Charter Article V. If a norm here ever conflicts with the Charter or the legal floor, the Charter and the floor control.
- **Enforcement is separate from the rules.** *What* is allowed lives here; *how* violations are handled (reactive, report-driven, human-decided, appealable) lives in Terms of Membership §3 and the moderation process. This Schedule sets the norms; it does not change the due-process guarantees.

1. Community conduct norms

Members agree to treat neighbors as neighbors. The following are the baseline community norms; members may refine them by vote.

1.1 Civility and good faith. Engage others in good faith. Disagreement, criticism, and robust debate are welcome; personal attacks, demeaning treatment, and bad-faith disruption are not.

1.2 Harassment. No harassment — including targeted insults, repeated unwanted contact, pile-ons, or intimidation of another member. Harassment is judged by its effect on a reasonable neigh-

bor, not only by the intent of the person doing it.

1.3 Hate and dehumanization. No content that attacks or dehumanizes people on the basis of who they are (for example race, ethnicity, national origin, religion, disability, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, or age). *[Cohort to confirm the protected-characteristic list and align it with Oregon law.]*

1.4 Privacy of neighbors. No sharing of another person's private information without consent (doxxing), and no impersonation of another member, official, or organization.

1.5 Honesty about who you are. One account per member. Do not misrepresent your residency, create fake or duplicate accounts, or evade verification or moderation.

1.6 Spam and manipulation. No spam, mass unsolicited messaging, vote manipulation, or coordinated inauthentic behavior. Surfacing and sorting on Steppe are chronological/proximity-based by design; do not attempt to game ranking or flood proposals.

1.7 Keep it local and human. Steppe is a place for real neighbors. Automated scraping, bulk data extraction, and off-platform commercial harvesting of member content are not permitted.

2. The Exchange (marketplace listings)

Steppe hosts member listings. The Exchange is **listings-only** — Steppe processes, holds, and escrows **no** money, and is not a party to any transaction (Terms §4; Charter canon). Members arrange anything that follows off-platform, at their own arrangement and risk.

2.1 Permitted listing categories (*member-governed; initial defaults*):

- **Needs** — requests for help, items, or services a neighbor is looking for.
- **Offers** — items or help a neighbor is giving or lending.
- **Goods** — physical items offered to neighbors. *[Cohort to confirm whether for-sale goods are permitted and, if so, how this squares with the “no commercial solicitation” norm in §2.3 — see reconciliation note.]*
- **Jobs** — local, occasional, or community work. *[Same reconciliation note.]*
- **Mutual aid** — no-cost help freely offered or requested.
- **Events** — gatherings, meetings, and neighborhood happenings (see §3).

2.2 Prohibited items and listings (*member-governed; initial defaults, on top of the legal floor*):

- anything on the legal floor (Terms §2) — always prohibited, never votable back in;
- weapons and ammunition, and controlled substances (including cannabis, notwithstanding Oregon legality) *[cohort to confirm]*;
- live animals *[cohort to confirm]*;
- recalled, counterfeit, or stolen goods;
- adult/sexual services;
- multi-level-marketing recruitment, financial-instrument sales, and get-rich schemes;
- anything requiring a professional license the lister does not hold (for example medical, legal, or financial advice offered as a service).

2.3 Commercial-solicitation norm (reconciliation required). Steppe is not a general advertising marketplace, and broad commercial solicitation is discouraged; commercial *discovery* is intended to live with Steppe's partner, Redmond Compass, not on-platform. **Open item for the cohort and**

counsel: define the exact line between a permitted member Exchange listing (a neighbor offering goods or occasional work) and prohibited commercial solicitation (a business advertising), and state it identically here and in both Terms surfaces. Today the formal Terms permit “goods” and “jobs” listings while the consent-gate Terms bar commercial soliciting — this Schedule is the right home for the settled rule, once decided.

2.4 Reporting. Any member may report a listing; moderators act on reports under Terms §3. Verified residency is the primary deterrent against bad-faith dealing.

3. Groups and events

3.1 Member-run. Groups, neighborhood events, gatherings, and mutual-aid activity are created and run by members, not by Steppe. Steppe verifies residency but does not otherwise vet members and is not a party to what members arrange. Meet safely and use good judgment.

3.2 Group norms. A group may adopt its own additional norms so long as they sit **above** these community defaults and the legal floor — a group may be stricter, never more permissive than the floor. Group maintainers apply group norms subject to the same report-and-appeal process.

3.3 Events. Event listings must be accurate as to time, place, and host. Events may not be used to route around the prohibited-items list or the legal floor. *[Cohort/counsel to confirm any safety, insurance, or waiver expectations for in-person gatherings — see the liability note in the review annex.]*

4. Content norms

4.1 Ownership and license. Members keep ownership of what they post; Steppe holds only the limited license needed to store and display content to operate the service (Terms §5). Content norms never transfer ownership or permit advertising, profiling, or sale.

4.2 No images on community content, by default. Consistent with Steppe’s privacy-by-architecture posture, general community content is text-first. *[Cohort to confirm the scope of the “no-images” default and its exceptions; note that verification evidence is expressly exempt and is deleted immediately upon a verification decision.]*

4.3 Minors. Steppe is an adults-only (18+) platform at this time; content directed at or soliciting minors is prohibited. A future 13-17 version, if built, will carry its own protections and its own norms adopted by member vote.

5. Relationship to enforcement and appeals

Nothing in this Schedule changes the moderation guarantees: enforcement is reactive and report-driven, a human (never an automated system) makes every consequential decision, outcomes are recorded in the public transparency log, and any action can be appealed through the governance process (Terms §3; Charter Article IV.7). Automation may surface or sort reports; it never decides.

6. Amendment log

Version	Date	Change	Process
v0.1 (draft)	2026-07-08	Initial draft created to fill the reference gap (cited in the decision record and /legal/terms but not previously written). Not yet ratified.	Pending founding-cohort ratification

Initial defaults marked “[cohort to confirm]” are placeholders for the founding membership to set through the first governance cycle. Once ratified, this Schedule is amendable by Major Policy vote (60%, quorum met) except where an item touches an Entrenched Commitment.